Before you start

This guide explains how to run the portfolio website on Windows from the project folder.

`Project folder: C:\Users\chand\OneDrive\Desktop\Portifolio`

You need Python installed. Open the project folder in VS Code, then choose Terminal > New Terminal. The commands below are for PowerShell.

1. Open the project folder

In VS Code, select File > Open Folder and choose the Portifolio folder. Confirm that manage.py and requirements.txt are visible in the Explorer.

2. Create a virtual environment (recommended)

```
python -m venv .venv
```

This creates an isolated Python environment in the project. You only need to create it once.

3. Activate the environment

```
.\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

When it is active, the terminal prompt usually starts with (.venv). If PowerShell blocks activation, use the Command Prompt alternative below.

```
.venv\Scripts\activate.bat
```

Install and prepare Django

4. Install the project requirements

```
python -m pip install --upgrade pip
```

```
python -m pip install -r requirements.txt
```

The requirements file installs Django. Internet access is needed the first time so pip can download it.

5. Prepare the SQLite database

```
python manage.py migrate
```

This creates or updates the local SQLite database used by the site. Running migrations makes sure the database schema is ready.

6. Check the Django project

```
python manage.py check
```

A successful check reports: System check identified no issues.

7. Start the local website

```
python manage.py runserver
```

Keep this terminal open while using the site. Django will print a local address, normally http://127.0.0.1:8000/.

Use the website

8. Open the portfolio in your browser

```
http://127.0.0.1:8000/
```

The site runs on your computer; this address is local to your machine. It is not automatically published on the internet.

Useful portfolio features

? Use the navigation links to move to About, Skills, Projects, Journey, Resume, and ? Certificates.

? Click Run in the code illustration to animate the sample and show its output.

? Skill chips and project cards can be clicked for interactive details or related ? links.

? Open or download the resume and certificates from their sections.

? The restaurant demo, if included in your current project version, is at ? http://127.0.0.1:8000/restaurant/.

9. Stop the server

Return to the terminal running Django and press Ctrl+C. To start again later, reopen the project, activate .venv, and run the server command.

Troubleshooting

? ?python is not recognized?: install Python and enable ?Add Python to PATH?, then ? reopen VS Code.

? ?No module named django?: activate .venv and run python -m pip install -r ? requirements.txt.

? Port 8000 is busy: run python manage.py runserver 8001 and open ? http://127.0.0.1:8001/.

? Changes are not visible: save your files, then hard-refresh the browser with ? Ctrl+F5.

? Do not close the terminal while using the local site; closing it stops the server.

```
Quick start after setup: .\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1  >  python
manage.py runserver
```